

Word family: **adult** / **adults** / **adulthood** / **adult-like** / **adulthood**

Base word: **adult**

Plural noun: **adults**

Part of speech: mainly **noun** and **adjective**

Related forms:

adulthood (n.) — 成年期；成人階段

adult-like (adj.) — 像成人的；成熟得像大人的

adulthood (informal n./v.-like usage) — 做成年人要處理的事；處理成人責任

Useful extensions:

an adult

adult life

adult education

adult learner

adult behaviour

adult supervision

adult responsibility

adult population

adult content

young adult

adulthood

reach adulthood

enter adulthood

adulthood (informal)

Meaning in this passage

> **Adults** often get trapped in routine, whereas children like Leo can turn an ordinary afternoon into a little adventure.

Here, **adults** means:

fully grown people who are no longer children — 成年人；成人

The sentence contrasts **adults** with **children**.

中文翻譯：

成年人往往容易被日常規律困住，而像 Leo 這樣的孩子卻可以把一個普通的下午變成一場小小的冒險。

So here:

adult = 成年人；已經長大、不再是小孩的人

1. **adult (成年人) — 成人；成年人**

This is the core noun meaning and the one used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> **Adults** often get trapped in routine.

成年人往往容易被日常規律困住。

Practice 2

> Children must be accompanied by an **adult**.

兒童必須由一名**成年人**陪同。

Practice 3

> There were three **adults** and two children in the group.

那一組有三名**成年人**和兩名小孩。

MCQ-ready definition:

adult = 已經長大、在法律或一般社會概念上不再屬於兒童的人

2. **adult (成年的；成人的) — 成年的；成人相關的**

As an adjective, **adult** describes people or things connected with adults.

Practice 1

> He entered **adult life** with very little money.

他幾乎沒有甚麼錢便開始了**成年人的生活**。

Practice 2

> The course is designed for **adult learners**.

這門課是為**成年學習者**設計的。

MCQ-ready definition:

adult + noun = 與成年人或成年階段有關的

3. **adult life — 成年生活**

Practice 1

> **Adult life** brings more freedom but also more responsibility.

成年生活帶來更多自由，也帶來更多責任。

Practice 2

> She spent most of her **adult life** abroad.

她大部分**成年生活**都在外國度過。

MCQ-ready definition:

adult life = 一個人成年之後的人生階段與生活

4. **adult responsibility — 成年人的責任**

Practice 1

> Paying bills is one of the less exciting **adult responsibilities**.

繳帳單是其中一項不太令人興奮的**成年人責任**。

Practice 2

> He gradually learned to handle **adult responsibilities**.

他逐漸學會處理各種**成年人責任**。

MCQ-ready definition:

adult responsibility = 一般由成年人承擔的工作、義務或生活責任

5. **adult behaviour** — 成人式行為；成熟行為

Practice 1

> The teacher expected more **adult behaviour** from the older students.

老師期望年紀較大的學生有更**成熟的行為表現**。

Practice 2

> He showed surprisingly **adult behaviour** for his age.

以他的年紀來說，他表現出令人意外的**成熟舉止**。

MCQ-ready definition:

adult behaviour = 被視為成熟、負責任、像成年人般的行為

6. **adult supervision** — 成人監督 / 陪同

Practice 1

> Children may use the pool only under **adult supervision**.

兒童只可在**成年人監督**下使用泳池。

Practice 2

> The activity requires **adult supervision**.

這項活動需要**成人陪同監督**。

MCQ-ready definition:

adult supervision = 由成年人在場監督、照看或負責安全

7. **adult education** — 成人教育

Practice 1

> She returned to study through an **adult education** programme.

她透過**成人教育**課程重新進修。

Practice 2

> The college offers evening classes in **adult education**.

那間學院提供**成人教育**晚間課程。

MCQ-ready definition:

adult education = 為已成年人士提供的教育或進修課程

8. **adult learner** — 成年學習者

Practice 1

> **Adult learners** often have different needs from school students.

成年學習者的需要通常與在校學生不同。

Practice 2

> The course is flexible enough for busy **adult learners**.

這門課的安排很有彈性，適合忙碌的**成年學習者**。

MCQ-ready definition:

adult learner = 已成年、正在接受教育或進修的人

9. **adult population** — 成年人口

Practice 1

> Most of the **adult population** has access to the internet.

大部分**成年人口**都可以使用互聯網。

Practice 2

> The survey focused on the **adult population**.

這項調查主要針對**成年人口**。

MCQ-ready definition:

****adult population = 一個地區或群體中已成年的人口****

10. ****adult animal — 成年動物****

****Adult**** also applies to animals.

Practice 1

> An ****adult elephant**** can weigh several tonnes.

一頭****成年大象****可重達數噸。

Practice 2

> The young bird looks very different from the ****adult****.

幼鳥和****成年鳥****看起來很不一樣。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****adult = 動物已發育成熟、不再處於幼年階段的****

11. ****adult stage / adult form — 成體階段；成蟲 / 成熟形態****

Common in biology.

Practice 1

> The insect reaches its ****adult stage**** after several weeks.

這種昆蟲數星期後會進入****成體階段****。

Practice 2

> The ****adult form**** looks completely different from the larva.

這種生物的****成體形態****與幼蟲完全不同。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****adult = 生物完成主要發育並進入成熟階段的****

12. **adulthood — 成年期；成人階段**

Practice 1

> He moved abroad in early **adulthood**.

他在**成年早期**移居外國。

Practice 2

> Habits formed in childhood can continue into **adulthood**.

童年形成的習慣可以延續到**成年期**。

MCQ-ready definition:

adulthood = 一個人成年之後所處的人生階段

13. **reach adulthood — 成年；到達成年階段**

Practice 1

> Many people change significantly before they **reach adulthood**.

很多人在**成年之前**都會有很大改變。

Practice 2

> The animal takes several years to **reach adulthood**.

這種動物需要數年才會**發育成熟**。

MCQ-ready definition:

reach adulthood = 到達身體或社會上被視為成年 / 成熟的階段

14. **enter adulthood — 進入成年期**

Practice 1

> Young people face many choices as they **enter adulthood**.

年輕人**進入成年期**時會面對很多選擇。

Practice 2

> She became more independent as she **entered adulthood**.

她**進入成年期**後變得更獨立。

MCQ-ready definition:

enter adulthood = 開始進入成年人的人生階段

15. **young adult — 年輕成年人；青少年 / 青年類型**

This expression has two common uses.

Human age group

= 年輕成年人

Publishing

= 青少年 / 青年讀物類別

Practice 1

> The programme is aimed at **young adults**.

這個計劃主要針對**年輕成年人**。

Practice 2

> She writes **young adult fiction**.

她創作**青少年小說 / 青年小說**。

MCQ-ready definition:

young adult = 剛進入成年期的年輕人；也可指以青少年讀者為主要對象的作品類別

16. **adult content — 成人內容**

Here, **adult** is a euphemistic/category label.

Practice 1

> The website contains **adult content**.

這個網站含有**成人內容**。

Practice 2

> The programme is restricted because of **adult themes**.

這個節目因包含**成人題材**而受到觀看限制。

MCQ-ready definition:

adult content/themes = 因涉及性、暴力或其他成熟題材而主要供成年人觀看的內容

17. **adult-only** — 只限成人的

Practice 1

> This is an **adult-only** event.

這是一個**只限成年人參加**的活動。

Practice 2

> The hotel has an **adult-only** pool area.

這間酒店設有**只限成人使用**的泳池區。

MCQ-ready definition:

adult-only = 只容許成年人參與、進入或使用的

18. **adult-like** — 像成人的；成熟的

Practice 1

> He showed remarkably **adult-like patience**.

他表現出相當**成熟、像成人般的耐性**。

Practice 2

> Her **adult-like confidence** surprised everyone.

她那種**像成年人般的自信**令大家都很驚訝。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****adult-like = 在行為、態度或特質上像成年人般成熟的****

19. ****adulthood (informal) — 做成年人要處理的事****

Modern informal usage.

Practice 1

> Paying bills and doing taxes are part of ****adulthood****.

繳帳單和處理稅務都是****做成年人要面對的事****。

Practice 2

> I don't feel like ****adulthood**** today.

我今天不太想****處理那些成年人生活中的責任****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****adulthood = 處理一般被視為成年人需要負責的日常責任****

****Register:**** informal, humorous, modern.

Important distinction 1: ****adult vs grown-up****

These overlap.

****adult****

neutral, standard, and used in formal contexts.

> an ****adult****

成年人

****grown-up****

more informal and child-oriented.

> Ask a **grown-up** for help.

找一個**大人**幫忙。

So for formal writing, **adult** is usually safer.

Important distinction 2: **adult vs mature**

These are not synonyms.

adult

means chronologically/biologically grown.

mature

describes behaviour, judgment, emotional development, or full development.

> He is an **adult**, but he isn't very **mature**.

他是成年人，但不太成熟。

Someone can be legally adult but emotionally immature.

Important distinction 3: **adult vs elderly**

adult

any grown person.

elderly

older adult, usually advanced age.

So:

all elderly people are adults, but not all adults are elderly.

Important distinction 4: **adult vs parent**

An **adult** does not necessarily have children.

A **parent** is someone who has a child.

> three adults and two children

does not mean the three adults are all parents.

Important distinction 5: **adult vs child**

This is the contrast in your passage.

adult

fully grown person

child

young person who has not reached adulthood

Your sentence contrasts their typical perspective:

> **Adults** may become trapped in routine, whereas **children** can make ordinary situations feel adventurous.

Important distinction 6: **adult vs adolescent**

adolescent

someone in the transition between childhood and adulthood, roughly the teenage developmental stage.

adult

someone who has reached adulthood.

So **adolescent** is developmental/transitional; **adult** is the mature category.

Important distinction 7: **adulthood vs maturity**

adulthood

a life stage.

maturity

a quality/state of being mature.

> He reached **adulthood** at eighteen.

他進入成年期。

> He showed great **maturity**.

他表現得很成熟。

Different concepts.

Important distinction 8: **adult animal vs mature animal**

They often overlap in biology, but:

adult

often means the final developmental stage.

mature

may emphasize sexual/reproductive or full physical maturity.

Context determines which is more precise.

Important distinction 9: **adult content does not simply mean content made by adults**

This is important.

> **adult content**

normally means material intended for adults because of mature themes.

It does **not** simply mean:

> content created by adults.

That would usually be:

> content created by adults.

Important distinction 10: **adulthood** is informal

Adulthood is common in casual modern speech, especially humorous contexts:

> I spent the morning doing boring **adulthood**.

But it is usually inappropriate in:

- * formal essays
- * academic writing
- * professional reports

Use phrases such as:

- * **adult responsibilities**
- * **everyday responsibilities**
- * **managing adult life**

instead.

Family-extension note

Adult has a fairly compact semantic core:

fully developed / no longer a child or juvenile

From that, several useful branches develop:

1. **human noun**

- * an adult
- * adults and children

2. **adult-related adjective**

- * adult life

- * adult education
- * adult responsibility

3. **biological maturity**

- * adult animal
- * adult stage

4. **age-restricted/mature material**

- * adult content
- * adult-only

5. **life-stage noun**

- * adulthood

6. **informal modern extension**

- * adulting

The main learner trap is not huge polysemy, but recognizing that **adult** can refer to **age/status**, **biological development**, **maturity-related categories**, and sometimes **age-restricted content**.

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea	
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an adult	成年人	grown person	
adult life	成年生活	life after childhood	
adult learner	成年學習者	grown learner	
adult education	成人教育	education for adults	
adult responsibility	成人責任	grown-up duties	
adult behaviour	成熟 / 成人式行為	behaviour expected of adults	
adult supervision	成人監督	adult oversight	
adult population	成年人口	adult demographic	
adult animal	成年動物	fully developed animal	
adult stage	成體階段	mature biological stage	
adulthood	成年期	adult life stage	
reach adulthood	成年 ; 成熟	reach adult stage	
enter adulthood	進入成年期	begin adult life	
young adult	年輕成年人 / 青年讀物類別	early adulthood / publishing category	
adult content	成人內容	mature/restricted material	

adult-only	只限成人的	restricted to adults	
adult-like	像成人的；成熟的	resembles adult behaviour	
adulting	做成年人的責任事務	informal adult responsibilities	

For your original sentence

> ****Adults**** often get trapped in routine, whereas children like Leo can turn an ordinary afternoon into a little adventure.

Here:

****adults = 成年人；已不再是小孩的人****

The sentence sets up a direct contrast:

****adults ↔ children****

The point is not biological maturity alone. In context, ****adults**** represents the grown-up perspective that can become overly structured and routine-driven.

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> ****成年人****往往容易被日常規律困住，而像 Leo 這樣的孩子卻能把一個普通的下午變成一場小小的冒險。

So the passage uses the straightforward ****human age/status sense**** of ****adult****.